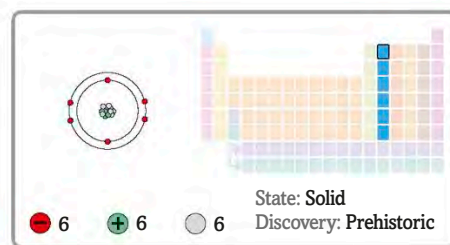


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C

Carbon

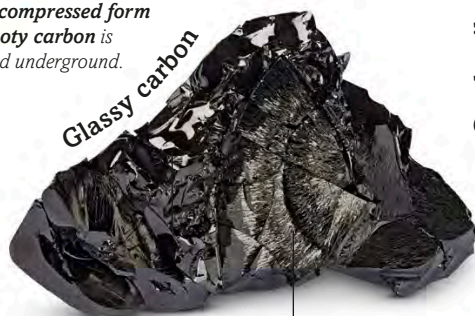


Forms



Coal

This compressed form of sooty carbon is formed underground.



Glassy carbon

Glossy surface



Crude oil

Mixture of liquid, carbon-rich compounds

This colourless crystal forms in magma deep underground.



Raw diamond

This diamond's brightness depends on its cut, which determines how many times light entering the gem will reflect inside.

The shiny, metallic surface feels soft and slippery.



Laboratory sample of graphite



Cut diamond

Carbon has the largest number of compounds of any element – with more than nine million known. Carbon is the fourth most common element in the Universe. Each carbon atom can bond to four others, allowing them to form chains and rings. Pure

carbon exists in three forms on Earth – **graphite**, **diamond**, and buckminsterfullerene (a structure based on 60 interlinked carbon atoms). Diamond is the hardest substance in nature. It is often used in jewellery. The blades of some **saws** are coated with diamonds, and